ReviiEwCo
More Reviews. More Trust. More Business

FREE GUIDE FOR HOME SERVICE OWNERS

GET FOUND BY AI

Homeowners are asking ChatGPT and Google's AI for contractors. Here's where those answers come from, what you can do about it this week, and a 15-minute test.

By Rob Warfield, founder of ReviiewCo · Greenville, SC · October 2026
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WHY NOW

"WHO'S THE BEST PLUMBER NEAR ME?" IS NOW A QUESTION PEOPLE ASK AI.

In BrightLocal's 2026 survey of 1,002 US adults, the share of people using ChatGPT or other AI tools for local recommendations jumped from 6% to 45% in one year. That makes AI the third most-used source for local recommendations, behind Google and Facebook.

Trust is mixed: 40% said they trust AI platforms for business recommendations, while 32% said they don't. But the shift is real, and the good news is that the groundwork is mostly the same work that helps you on Google Maps.

WHERE GOOGLE'S AI GETS ITS ANSWERS

This is the clearest part of the picture. Google's AI features that touch local searches, including Gemini in Google Maps, AI Overviews and AI Mode in Search, and the Gemini app, are built on Google Maps data.

- In December 2025, the Gemini app started showing local results with business photos, star ratings and location details pulled from Google Maps.
- Tap a business and you can see AI-written sections like "People talk most about" and "Tips from reviewers," which summarize that business's Google reviews.
- Google's developer documentation for Grounding with Google Maps says it pulls places, reviews, photos, addresses and hours from Maps, then answers from that data.

> **Bottom line:** your Google Business Profile and your reviews are the raw material for Google's AI.

WHERE CHATGPT GETS ITS ANSWERS

ChatGPT doesn't have its own map of businesses. When you ask it a local question, it searches the web and reads what it finds. What's been reported:

- Yelp has a direct data licensing relationship with OpenAI, according to Uberall.
- Uberall also says ChatGPT and most AI tools start their searches through Google or Bing, and that Google Business Profile data is treated as an authoritative source.
- An older Whitespark study found Facebook beat Yelp as the main review source in Bing Places in all but one city.

These findings don't line up perfectly, and AI tools change often. Anyone claiming certainty about where ChatGPT gets its local data is guessing.

Nobody can guarantee AI placement. No AI assistant publishes a ranking formula for local recommendations. Google says there's no way to request or pay for a better local ranking. OpenAI says placement in ChatGPT search isn't guaranteed. If someone guarantees you'll show up when a homeowner asks ChatGPT for a roofer, ask them how.

5 THINGS YOU CAN DO THIS WEEK

1. Finish your Google Business Profile

Categories, services, service area, hours, phone, website and photos: filled in and correct.

2. Keep real reviews coming in steadily

AI review summaries are built from what your customers write. Ask every customer, the same way, soon after the job, with a direct link. Don't script what they say and don't only ask the happy ones. (Free link + QR code: reviiewco.com/tools/google-review-link-generator)

3. Make your business info match everywhere

Google, Bing, Yelp, Facebook: same business name, address, phone and hours. Mismatched info makes it harder for any system to be sure who you are.

4. Give each service its own page on your website

Water heater installs, drain cleaning and repiping each get their own page: what you do, where, and what to expect. Experts in Whitespark's 2026 survey ranked this near the top for AI visibility, and it helps the humans who land on your site.

5. Get mentioned on real local and industry sites

Local news, your chamber of commerce, manufacturer dealer pages, trade associations, sponsorships, and legitimate "best of" lists put together by someone else. Don't pay for fake ones. Google confirmed in May 2026 that its spam policies cover AI Overviews and AI Mode too.

TEST IT YOURSELF IN 15 MINUTES

1. Open ChatGPT, the Gemini app, and Google's AI Mode.
2. In each, ask: "Who's the best [your trade] in [your town]?"
3. Write down which businesses come up in each.

4. Look at the sources each tool cites: Google Maps, Yelp, Facebook, Angi, a news article, a business website?
5. Check whether you're mentioned, and whether your phone, hours and services are right.
6. Repeat with a few wordings, like "emergency plumber near me."

Results vary by person, place and time, so look for patterns. If the same competitor keeps coming up and every tool cites the same directory, that tells you where AI is looking in your market.

SOURCES

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- Cloutly, Does ChatGPT Recommend Your Business?: cloutly.com
- Uberall, Visibility in ChatGPT and LLMs: uberall.com
- Whitespark, 2026 Local Search Ranking Factors; Want to Rank in ChatGPT?: whitespark.ca
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- Full article: reviiewco.com/blog/where-ai-gets-local-recommendations

DO IT YOURSELF, OR HAND IT OFF

THAT'S THE WHOLE PLAYBOOK.

Everything above works, and you can do every bit of it yourself. Most owners we talk to don't have the time, because they're out doing the work. That's exactly what ReviiewCo is for.

Do it yourself

- Ask every customer, every job, the same way
- Work your old customer list in steady batches
- Reply to every review within a few days
- Keep it going when the schedule gets busy

Or we do it for you

- A friendly text after every job, plus up to two reminders
- Your past-customer list worked for you
- A reply to every review, in your voice
- Missed-Call-Text Back included

$297/month. No contract. No setup fee.

Guarantee: at least 10 new Google reviews in 30 days when you send us a list of 300+ past customers, or every dollar back. The 30 days start once we have your list and access to your Google profile.

Talk it through with Rob (30 min, no pressure)
reviiewco.com/book

Get started
reviiewco.com/start

Call or text, answered 24/7
864-528-1909

General information, not legal advice. Example names, reviews and texts are illustrations, not real customers.